

CLAT GK - Pilot Test 1

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Budget 2026-27, repo rate holds and a strong Q1 GDP print

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman presented the Union Budget for 2026-27 in Parliament on 1 February 2026, a Sunday, the first time a Budget was delivered on that day in independent India. It was her ninth consecutive Budget. She set the fiscal deficit target for 2026-27 at 4.3 per cent of GDP, slightly below the 4.4 per cent revised estimate for 2025-26, and said she had fulfilled her 2021-22 commitment to bring the deficit below 4.5 per cent of GDP by 2025-26. The Budget raised capital expenditure to about Rs 12.2 lakh crore and projected the Centre's debt at 55.6 per cent of GDP, with the stated aim of moving towards around 50 per cent by March 2031. Total expenditure was estimated at Rs 53.47 lakh crore, or 13.6 per cent of GDP.

Five days later, on 6 February 2026, the Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee, chaired by Governor Sanjay Malhotra, kept the policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent with a neutral stance. It was the Governor's first policy review after the Budget. The Committee repeated the decision on 5 June 2026, citing elevated crude oil prices, a weaker rupee and monsoon concerns. At its meeting of 3 to 5 August 2026, the MPC voted unanimously to hold the rate at 5.25 per cent once more and retained the neutral stance. The RBI projected real GDP growth of 6.7 per cent and consumer price inflation of 5.0 per cent for 2026-27. The repo rate had been lowered by a cumulative 125 basis points during 2025 before the pause began.

The central bank's growth projection was overtaken by official data on 31 August 2026. The National Statistical Office reported that India's real GDP grew 7.8 per cent in April-June 2026, the first quarter of 2026-27, against a Reuters poll median of 7.1 per cent and the RBI's own estimate of 7 per cent. Real GDP was put at Rs 81.36 lakh crore, while nominal GDP rose 10.3 per cent to Rs 88.27 lakh crore. Gross value added grew 8.2 per cent, led by services, and gross fixed capital formation rose 11.9 per cent, a sign that public investment was feeding through. ICRA raised its full-year forecast to 7.1 per cent from 6.7 per cent, though analysts cautioned that high crude prices and inflation remained risks.

The MPC met again from 5 to 7 October 2026. Economists were divided on whether the Committee would hold or raise rates, which would have been the first increase since February 2023.

Q1. The Union Budget presented in Parliament each year is constitutionally described as the 'annual financial statement'. Which Article of the Constitution of India requires it to be laid before both Houses?

- (A) Article 110
- (B) Article 112
- (C) Article 114
- (D) Article 265

Q2. The National Statistical Office, which released the Q1 2026-27 GDP estimate, functions under which Union Ministry?

- (A) Ministry of Finance
- (B) NITI Aayog
- (C) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- (D) Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Q3. Assertion (A): Salaries of Supreme Court judges are not subject to a vote by the Lok Sabha when the Budget is passed.

Reason (R): Such expenditure is charged on the Consolidated Fund of India under Article 112(3).

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q4. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Annual Financial Statement	A. Article 113
II. Demands for Grants	B. Article 112
III. CPI inflation target set for the MPC	C. Section 45ZB of the RBI Act, 1934
IV. Statutory basis for constituting the MPC	D. 4 per cent with a tolerance band of 2 per cent either side

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q5. Statement I. The Monetary Policy Committee has six members, three of whom are from the Reserve Bank of India including the Governor as ex-officio chairperson.

Statement II. The flexible inflation target for the MPC is measured against CPI Combined, with an upper tolerance level of 6 per cent and a lower level of 2 per cent.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q6. Statement I. The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Act was enacted in 2003.

Statement II. The Act originally aimed to limit the Centre's fiscal deficit to 3 per cent of GDP.

Statement III. The 2018 amendment allows deviation from the fiscal deficit target by up to 1 percentage point of GDP under an escape clause.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) All of the above

FIFA World Cup 2026: Spain crowned champions

The 2026 FIFA World Cup, the first to be hosted jointly by three nations, ran for 39 days from 11 June to 19 July 2026. It was also the first edition expanded to 48 teams, split into 12 groups of four, and featured a record 104 matches across 16 host cities, of which 11 were in the United States, three in Mexico and two in Canada. The opening game on 11 June was played at the Estadio Azteca in Mexico City, where Mexico beat South Africa 2-0 through goals from Julian Quinones and Raul Jimenez. The

match produced three red cards, the most in any World Cup opener, and ended a run of seven World Cup openers in which the Mexicans had failed to win. The same stadium thereby became the first in football history to stage matches at three different World Cups.

The tournament ended on 19 July at MetLife Stadium in New Jersey, where Spain defeated defending champion Argentina 1-0 after extra time before a crowd of 80,663. Ferran Torres scored the only goal 39 seconds into the second period of extra time, in the 106th minute, turning in a low cross from Nico Williams. Argentina had been reduced to ten men late in normal time when Enzo Fernandez received a second yellow card, and goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez made 11 saves, a record for a World Cup final, without being able to deny Spain. The victory gave Spain its second world title and denied Argentina a fourth.

Spain also dominated the individual honours announced after the final. Midfielder Rodri was named winner of the Golden Ball as the best player of the tournament, while goalkeeper Unai Simon took the Golden Glove after conceding just one goal in eight matches. Pau Cubarsi was named best young player, and the Fair Play award went to the Netherlands. The Golden Boot, however, went to France's Kylian Mbappe, who scored 10 goals in eight matches and finished two clear of the second-placed finisher on eight goals. Jude Bellingham and Erling Haaland tied for third place with seven goals each.

The Golden Ball, Golden Glove and Best Young Player awards are chosen by media votes from a shortlist drawn up by FIFA's Technical Study Group. For Mbappe, the award extended a remarkable run at the sport's biggest event: he became the first player to win the top scorer award at two consecutive World Cups. For Spain, whose squad blended experienced campaigners with teenage talent, the result capped a tournament in which its defence was breached only once. The tournament's expanded format meant that the eventual champion had to navigate a new round of 32, introduced because the top two sides from every group and the eight best third-placed teams advanced.

Q7. Spain's win over Argentina in the 2026 final was its second World Cup title. In which year did Spain win its first, beating the Netherlands 1-0 after extra time?

- (A) 2006
- (B) 2010
- (C) 2014
- (D) 2008

Q8. Argentina entered the 2026 final as defending champion. Which player won the Golden Ball at the 2022 World Cup, and remains the only player to have won that award twice?

- (A) Luka Modric
- (B) Kylian Mbappe
- (C) Lionel Messi
- (D) Antoine Griezmann

Q9. Assertion (A): The Estadio Azteca in Mexico City became the first stadium in football history to host matches at three different FIFA World Cups when the 2026 tournament opened there.

Reason (R): The Estadio Azteca had earlier hosted World Cup matches in 1970 and 1986.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q10. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 2010 World Cup final	A. Soccer City, Johannesburg
II. 2022 World Cup final	B. Lusail Stadium, Lusail
III. 2026 World Cup final	C. MetLife Stadium, New Jersey
IV. 2026 World Cup opening match	D. Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q11. Statement I. Kylian Mbappe won the Golden Boot at the 2022 World Cup with eight goals.

Statement II. Argentina beat France in the 2022 final in regulation time, 2-1, without the need for extra time.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q12. Statement 1. The FIFA World Cup trophy was designed by the Italian sculptor Silvio Gazzaniga.

Statement 2. The trophy is made of 18-carat gold.

Statement 3. The trophy weighs about 6.175 kg.

Statement 4. The trophy is solid gold throughout, with no hollow interior.

How many of the above statements are incorrect?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Article 21 Widened: Menstrual Health and Passive Euthanasia

Two rulings delivered by the Supreme Court in the first quarter of 2026 have widened the reach of the right to life in different directions, and both were authored by Justice J.B. Pardiwala.

On 30 January 2026, a bench of Justices Pardiwala and R. Mahadevan decided *Dr. Jaya Thakur v. Government of India* (reported as 2026 INSC 97, Writ Petition (Civil) No. 1000 of 2022). The Court held that menstrual health is part of the right to life under Article 21, and that poor menstrual hygiene management is not merely a sanitation problem but a violation of the fundamental rights to equality, dignity and education. It said the absence of gender-segregated toilets and menstrual hygiene facilities is a constitutional barrier to schooling for adolescent girls, engaging Articles 14, 21 and 21A. The bench issued a continuing mandamus to the Union and the states. All government, government-aided and private schools must provide biodegradable sanitary napkins free of cost, maintain functional, gender-segregated and disabled-friendly toilets, and dispose of menstrual waste in line with the Solid Waste Management Rules. Private schools that fail to comply risk derecognition. The Court noted that policies existed on paper but implementation was inconsistent, and that several states, including Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh, had not even filed affidavits.

On 11 March 2026, a different bench of Justices Pardiwala and K.V. Viswanathan decided *Harish Rana v. Union of India* (2026 SCC OnLine SC 358). Rana, reported to be about 31 or 32 years old, had been in a persistent vegetative state for over thirteen years after a brain injury in 2013. His parents had first approached the Delhi High Court, which declined relief on the ground that he was not on mechanical life support and was not terminally ill. They then came to the Supreme Court in 2024, which gave them liberty to return if further directions were needed. On 13 January 2026, the judges personally met Rana's parents and his younger brother before reserving judgment.

The Court allowed withdrawal of life-sustaining treatment, including clinically assisted nutrition and hydration, applying the "best interest" principle and the guidelines flowing from *Common Cause v. Union of India* (2018), as modified in 2023. It waived the usual 30-day reconsideration period because all stakeholders agreed, and directed AIIMS, New Delhi, to admit him to its palliative care department. He was shifted on 14 March to the palliative care unit at the Dr B.R. Ambedkar Institute Rotary Cancer Hospital, AIIMS, where a team led by Dr Seema Mishra supervised a gradual withdrawal with palliative sedation. Rana died on 24 March 2026. Reports describe it as the first judicial implementation of India's passive euthanasia framework in an individual case.

Taken together, the judgments show the Court continuing to read Article 21 as more than mere animal existence, covering health, bodily autonomy and dignity from the school toilet to the hospital bed.

Q13. The Jaya Thakur ruling stressed that menstrual hygiene facilities are linked to the education of girls. Which Article of the Constitution expressly permits the State to make special provisions for women and children despite the bar on discrimination?

- (A) Article 15(3)
- (B) Article 16(4)
- (C) Article 14
- (D) Article 19(1)(g)

Q14. Which 1978 seven-judge Supreme Court decision, authored mainly by Justice Bhagwati, read the words 'procedure established by law' in Article 21 as requiring a procedure that is fair, just and reasonable, and so underpins the wide modern reading of the right to life?

- (A) *Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India*
- (B) *A.K. Gopalan v. State of Madras*
- (C) *Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala*
- (D) *Minerva Mills v. Union of India*

Q15. Assertion (A): Before Article 21A existed, the Supreme Court in *Unni Krishnan, J.P. v. State of Andhra Pradesh* (1993) had read a right to free education up to the age of 14 into Article 21.

Reason (R): Article 21A was later inserted into the Constitution by the Eighty-sixth Amendment Act, 2002, and the RTE Act 2009 is the law implementing it.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q16. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. <i>Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India</i>	A. 1978
II. <i>Unni Krishnan v. State of Andhra Pradesh</i>	B. 1993

III. Common Cause v. Union of India (Constitution Bench)	C. 2011
IV. Aruna Shanbaug v. Union of India	D. 2018

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q17. Statement I. Article 21A, guaranteeing free and compulsory education for children aged six to fourteen, was inserted by the Eighty-sixth Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002.

Statement II. Article 21A guarantees free and compulsory education to all children up to the age of eighteen.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q18. Statement 1. The Common Cause (2018) judgment on the right to die with dignity was delivered by a five-judge Constitution Bench.

Statement 2. Maneka Gandhi (1978) departed from the watertight-compartments approach to fundamental rights adopted in A.K. Gopalan (1950).

Statement 3. In Unni Krishnan (1993), the Supreme Court held that the right to education up to a professional degree flows directly from Article 21.

Statement 4. Aruna Shanbaug v. Union of India was decided in 2011 and allowed passive euthanasia in certain circumstances under court monitoring.

How many of the above statements are incorrect?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

India's BRICS Chairship 2026

India formally took over the BRICS chairship from Brazil on 1 January 2026, becoming chair of the grouping for the fourth time. Twelve days later, on 13 January, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar unveiled the logo, website and theme of the presidency in New Delhi. The theme, "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability", was tied by officials to the people-centric approach Prime Minister Narendra Modi had outlined at the previous year's summit in Rio de Janeiro. The chairship runs for the calendar year, from 1 January to 31 December, and the chair sets the agenda for meetings at every level, from sherpas and ministers to the leaders' summit.

The calendar of ministerial meetings began to fill in the middle of the year. Foreign ministers and heads of delegation from member and partner countries gathered at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on 14 and 15 May 2026. Jaishankar chaired the meeting, which was overshadowed by the crisis in West Asia, and the delegates later called on Modi. On 22 and 23 June, National Security Adviser Ajit Doval hosted the 16th meeting of BRICS national security advisers in the capital. Russia's Security Council Secretary Sergey Shoigu and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi were among those who attended. The agenda was built around non-traditional security challenges, and Doval used the sidelines to hold bilateral talks

with officials from Iran, Brazil, Ethiopia and South Africa.

The presidency culminated in the 18th BRICS Summit, held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on 12 and 13 September 2026. On the first day, Modi announced that leaders had adopted the New Delhi Declaration by consensus, with no member raising an objection. Reports said back-channel negotiations were needed to bridge sharp differences between Iran and the United Arab Emirates over the West Asia conflict. The 140-point document is divided into three chapters covering inclusive global governance, peace and security, and cultural and people-to-people cooperation. It backed a larger role for India and Brazil at the United Nations, criticised unilateral tariffs and secondary sanctions, and condemned the 22 April terror attack in Jammu and Kashmir. It also called for an immediate ceasefire in Gaza and endorsed India-led initiatives on financial risk, artificial intelligence and big-cat conservation.

The declaration also welcomed what it called significant progress under India's presidency and pledged support for China, which will take over the rotating chair in 2027. India's turn came at a time when the bloc, which now has eleven full members after its enlargement in recent years, is trying to balance members with very different positions on the conflicts in West Asia. Analysts noted that the ability to produce a consensus text, even if after hard bargaining, was the main diplomatic achievement of the Delhi summit.

Q19. The BRICS grouping's own multilateral lender, the New Development Bank, has its headquarters in which city?

- (A) Shanghai
- (B) New Delhi
- (C) Johannesburg
- (D) Moscow

Q20. Brazil chaired BRICS in 2025 before handing over to India. Which member held the chair in 2024, the year of the Kazan summit?

- (A) Russia
- (B) South Africa
- (C) China
- (D) India

Q21. Assertion (A): Indonesia is a full member of BRICS.

Reason (R): Brazil announced on 6 January 2025, during its own chairship, that Indonesia was formally joining the grouping as a full member.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q22. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 2011 BRICS summit	A. Durban
II. 2012 BRICS summit	B. Fortaleza
III. 2013 BRICS summit	C. New Delhi
IV. 2014 BRICS summit	D. Sanya

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q23. Statement I. Before 2026, India had chaired BRICS in 2012, 2016 and 2021.

Statement II. South Africa's admission in 2010 led the BRIC grouping to be renamed BRICS.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q24. Statement 1. The acronym BRIC was coined in 2001 by Goldman Sachs economist Jim O'Neill.

Statement 2. The first formal BRIC leaders' summit was held in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in June 2009.

Statement 3. South Africa attended its first summit as a full member at Sanya, China, in April 2011.

Statement 4. The Agreement on the New Development Bank was signed at the 2012 New Delhi summit.

How many of the above statements are incorrect?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

PSLV-C62 failure and the road to Gaganyaan

The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) began 2026 with a setback. On 12 January 2026, its Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle mission PSLV-C62 lifted off from Sriharikota carrying EOS-N1, a strategic hyperspectral Earth-observation satellite also referred to as Anvesha, along with 15 co-passenger payloads belonging to Indian and foreign organisations. The first two stages performed as planned, but ISRO reported an anomaly at the end of the third stage, known as PS3. ISRO chairman V. Narayanan said a disturbance in the rocket's roll rate had pushed the vehicle off its flight path, and the payloads did not reach their intended orbit. Among the lost payloads were Theos-2, an Earth-observation satellite built jointly by the United Kingdom and Thailand, and AyulSat, a refuelling demonstrator. The Spanish prototype Kestrel Initial Demonstrator was reported to have transmitted some data.

The failure drew attention because it was the second consecutive loss for the workhorse rocket. The previous mission, PSLV-C61 in May 2025, had also failed owing to a problem in the third stage. Reports said that a redesigned third-stage motor had undergone two static tests in October and November 2025 before C62 was cleared to fly, although the earlier committee's findings had not been made public. After C62, ISRO announced a failure analysis committee. Separately, in a departure from the agency's usual reliance on internal reviews, news reports citing sources said the government had set up a probe headed by K. VijayRaghavan, a former Principal Scientific Advisor to the Prime Minister, with former ISRO chairman S. Somanath as co-chairman. A report from Chennai dated 19 February carried the same details, but the government has not formally released the committee's findings.

The episode has implications for India's human spaceflight plans. The Gaganyaan programme, which aims to send Indian astronauts to low Earth orbit, depends on a series of uncrewed test flights. In January 2026 Narayanan said the first of these, G1, which will carry the half-humanoid robot

Vyommitra, was about 90 per cent complete after more than 8,000 ground tests and could fly by March 2026. That date passed without a launch. The mission is now listed for the fourth quarter of 2026, on a human-rated launch vehicle, with the crewed flight pencilled in for 2027 or later. ISRO has said that three uncrewed missions will precede it.

Meanwhile, India is also building new launch infrastructure. A second spaceport, intended mainly for small satellite launches, has been under construction since March 2025, and the government has targeted commissioning in the financial year 2026-27. Officials stress, however, that the existing launch complex will remain the primary site for all major rockets, including the PSLV and the GSLV.

Q25. The Sriharikota spaceport, from which PSLV-C62 was launched, is officially named after which scientist and former ISRO chairman?

- (A) Vikram Sarabhai
- (B) Satish Dhawan
- (C) A. P. J. Abdul Kalam
- (D) Homi J. Bhabha

Q26. Assertion (A): India's planned second spaceport at Kulasekarapattinam in Thoothukudi district, Tamil Nadu, is intended mainly for launching small satellites on the SSLV.

Reason (R): A launch site on the southern tip of the peninsula lets rockets fly directly south to polar orbits, avoiding the curved trajectory that Sriharikota launches need to stay clear of Sri Lanka.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q27. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. ISRO headquarters	A. Thiruvananthapuram
II. Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (lead centre for launch vehicles)	B. Bengaluru
III. Satish Dhawan Space Centre (Sriharikota)	C. Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh
IV. Kulasekarapattinam spaceport (under construction)	D. Thoothukudi district, Tamil Nadu

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q28. Statement I. The PSLV is a four-stage vehicle whose third stage (PS3) uses solid propellant.

Statement II. The very first PSLV flight, PSLV-D1 on 20 September 1993, successfully placed its satellite in orbit.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q29. Statement I. ISRO was formed on 15 August 1969, succeeding the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR) set up in 1962.

Statement II. ISRO's headquarters is located in Thiruvananthapuram.

Statement III. ISRO functions under the Department of Space.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) All of the above

Q30. The uncrewed Gaganyaan test flight G1 is planned on a human-rated version of which ISRO launch vehicle?

- (A) PSLV
- (B) SSLV
- (C) LVM3
- (D) GSLV Mk II